



Documentary Production

Course Name: Documentary Production

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Submitted to

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Director's Vision

Project: **আহত পাখি** | Documentary

Submitted by **Ebsan Zaman Dipto (221012038)**

Overview

Our documentary explores the aftermath of the July protests in Bangladesh, focusing on the personal story of Shumon and his son Emon, who was shot in his leg during the movement. We wanted to capture not only the physical consequences of the protests but also the emotional and social scars left on ordinary families. This is our first documentary, and it has been a deeply personal learning experience for us.

The Story We Wanted to Tell

At the heart of the film is Shumon, a rickshaw puller from Badda, Dhaka, who continues to struggle with caring for his son. Emon's injury is a permanent reminder of that day, shaping the family's daily life, work, and future. Although the government provided some compensation, it was not enough to cover medical costs and other losses, including the theft of Shumon's rickshaw. Through their story, we aim to show how political violence leaves lasting, personal scars that go beyond the headlines.

Approach and Method

We initially planned a fully observational approach, letting events unfold naturally in front of the camera. However, our subjects were interactive and responsive to our presence. To honor their experience, we adapted our method, allowing the story to develop collaboratively. While we couldn't fully go beneath the surface, this approach helped maintain authenticity while respecting the family's comfort and agency.

Visual and Narrative Style

Visually and narratively, we employed L-cuts, J-cuts, and jump cuts to create an intimate, reflective rhythm. These techniques allowed us to emphasize both the emotional weight of the story and the quiet moments of struggle and resilience. We wanted the audience to feel the tension, hope, and persistence embedded in the family's life.

Why This Story Matters

This film is a testament to Shumon's determination and Emon's courage. It also reflects the broader consequences of political unrest on ordinary lives. We hope the documentary not only informs but humanizes the aftermath of the July protests, reminding the audience that these events are not distant news; they are lived experiences with lasting effects.

Collaboration

Collaborating with Anirban and our friends throughout the process has been invaluable. Every contribution from research and shooting to editing helped shape a documentary that is deeply personal, empathetic, and respectful to its subjects.

Link of the documentary “আহত পাখি”:

<https://youtu.be/j0US8YsZvoQ>



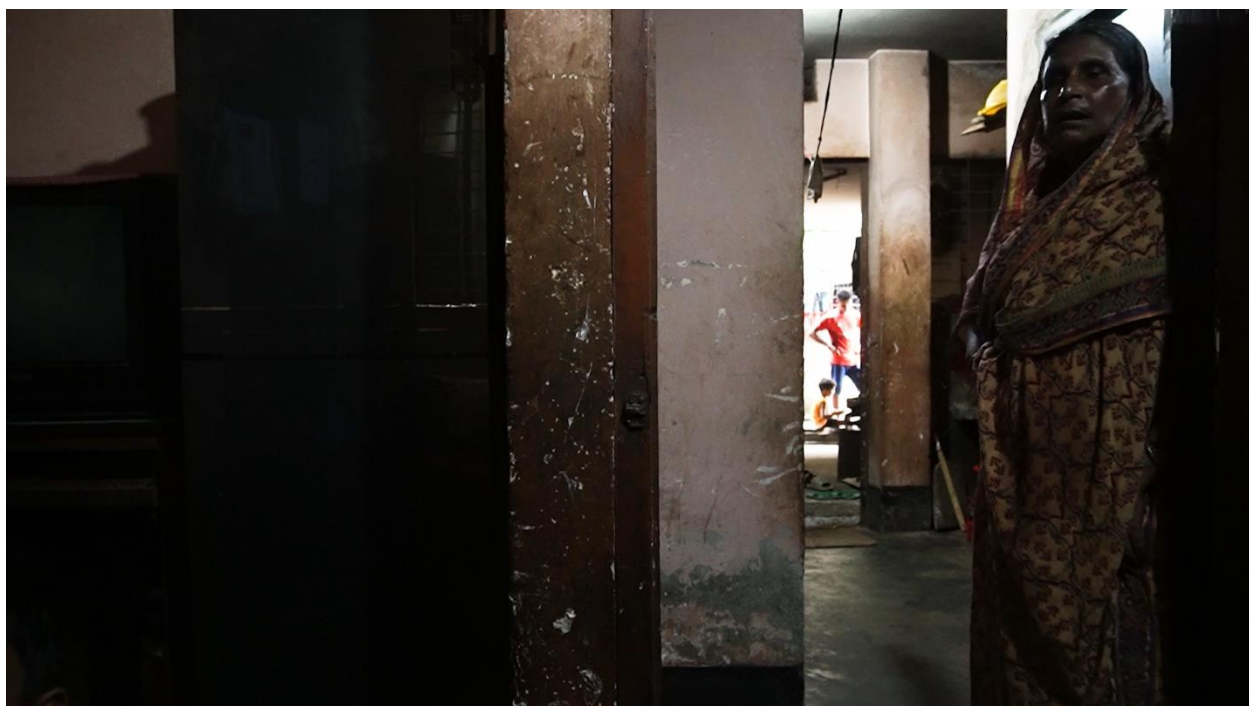
Frame 1 আহত পাখি



Frame 2 আহত পাখি



Frame 3 আহত পাখি



Frame 4 আহত পাখি

Learnings and Outcomes (Self-reflection):

- I learned how to plan and shoot a documentary using an observational approach.
- I can now explain how political events affect the daily lives of ordinary families.
- I understood how to adapt a filming method when subjects respond naturally to the camera.
- I learned how to use editing techniques to build emotional depth in a documentary.